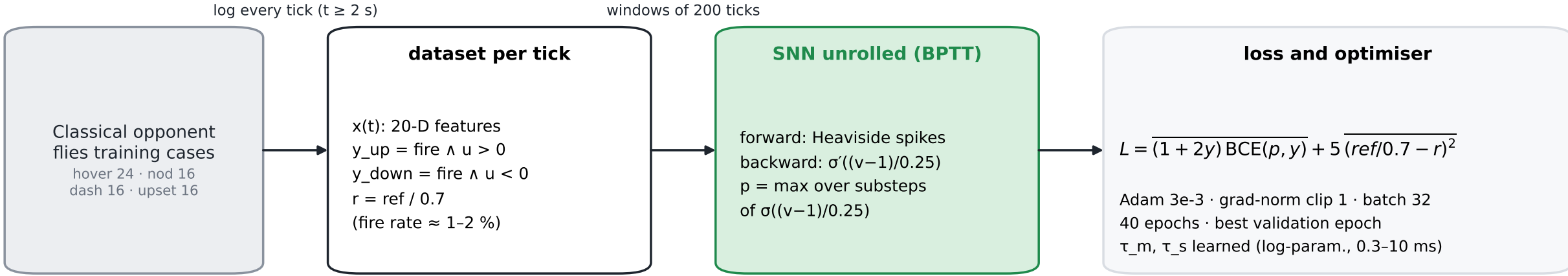
Step 1 — imitation: learn when to fire (and which way) from the strongest classical controller



Why: from scratch, NEAT / RL never found phase-locked firing (wrong basin, flat objective). Imitation gives a controller that already flies with correctly phased pulses (val. precision ≈ 0.45, recall ≈ 0.65–0.70); it need not copy the teacher exactly — step 2 improves on it.